

Original Dashboard – Cognitive Load Audit

1

Dense Prose Block

RED ZONE

The dashboard opens with a long paragraph and an italic quote. For a busy policy advisor, this is an immediate barrier — there is no headline, no key number, and no clear takeaway. The data is buried inside text that demands reading before anything useful is visible.

2

31-Country Unsortable Table

RED ZONE

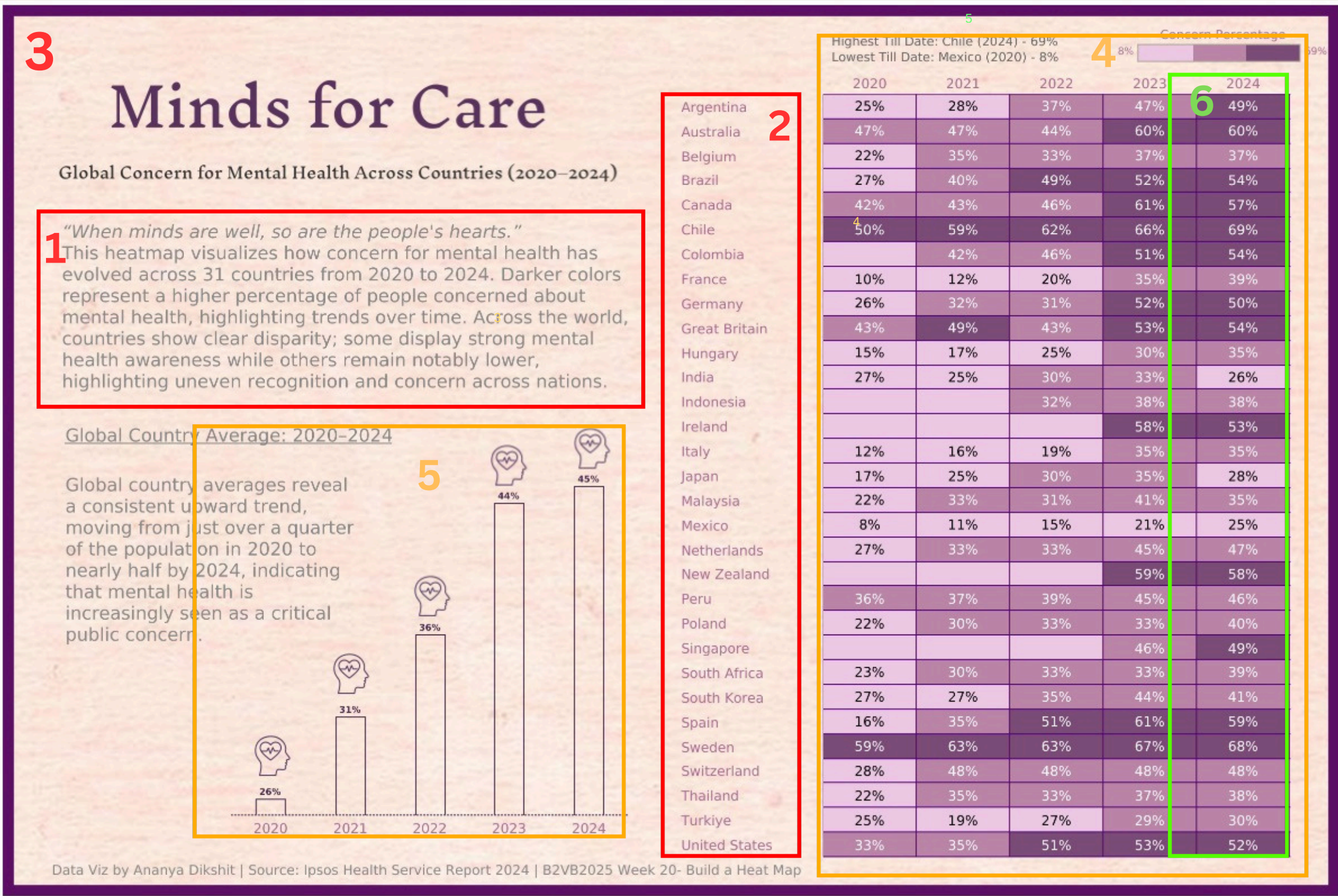
The heatmap lists all 31 countries in fixed alphabetical order. There is no way to sort, filter, or search. A policy advisor looking for Australia must scroll through every country manually — slow, frustrating, and unnecessary in a well-designed dashboard.

3

No Interactivity or Filtering

RED ZONE

The entire dashboard is fully static — no hover, no filters, no year selector, no drill-down. The advisor cannot isolate their country or a single year, forcing them to process the entire dataset at once with no control.



4

5 Years at Equal Visual Weight

YELLOW ZONE

All five year columns — 2020 through 2024 — are displayed at identical size with no visual difference. For a policy advisor, only 2024 matters for current decisions. The most important column is hidden in plain sight with no emphasis to guide the eye.

5

Decorative Icon Bar Chart

YELLOW ZONE

The global average trend is shown using head-shaped icons instead of standard bars. There is no numerical axis, no scale, and no exact values. While visually interesting, it tells the advisor nothing precise — they cannot read how much the average changed year to year.

6

Golden Thread — 2024 Concern %

KEEP & AMPLIFY

The 2024 column is the only data point the advisor needs. It shows exactly which countries have the highest mental health concern right now. Australia at 60% versus a global average of 45% is the single number that justifies budget decisions. This is the centrepiece of the pivot.

● RED — Cognitive Overload • ZONES 1, 2, 3 • REMOVED

Elements that directly block or overwhelm the persona. These are high-friction areas where the advisor would stop, get confused, or give up. In the pivot, these elements were completely removed or replaced with simpler alternatives.

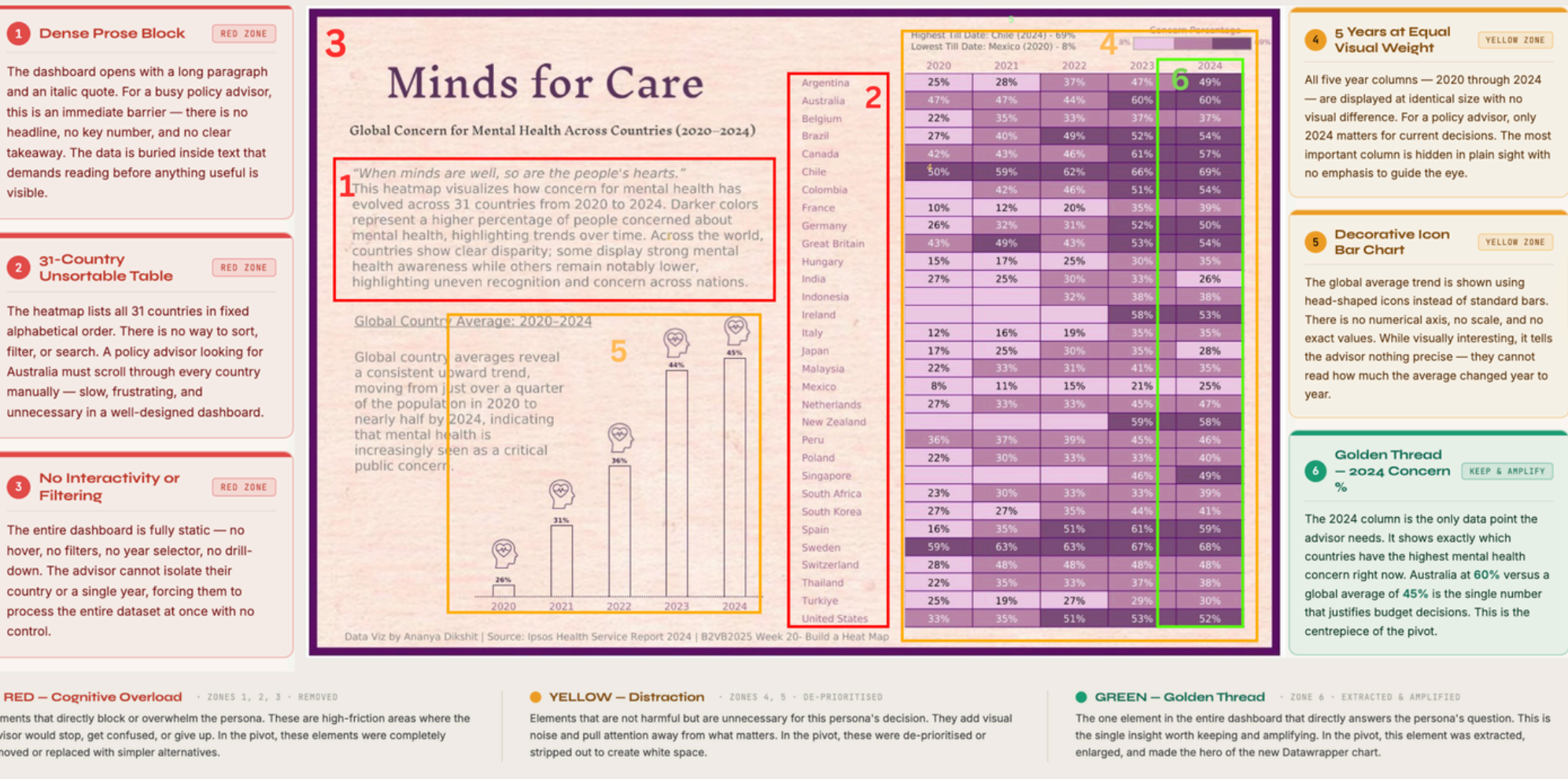
● YELLOW — Distraction • ZONES 4, 5 • DE-PRIORITISED

Elements that are not harmful but are unnecessary for this persona's decision. They add visual noise and pull attention away from what matters. In the pivot, these were de-prioritised or stripped out to create white space.

● GREEN — Golden Thread • ZONE 6 • EXTRACTED & AMPLIFIED

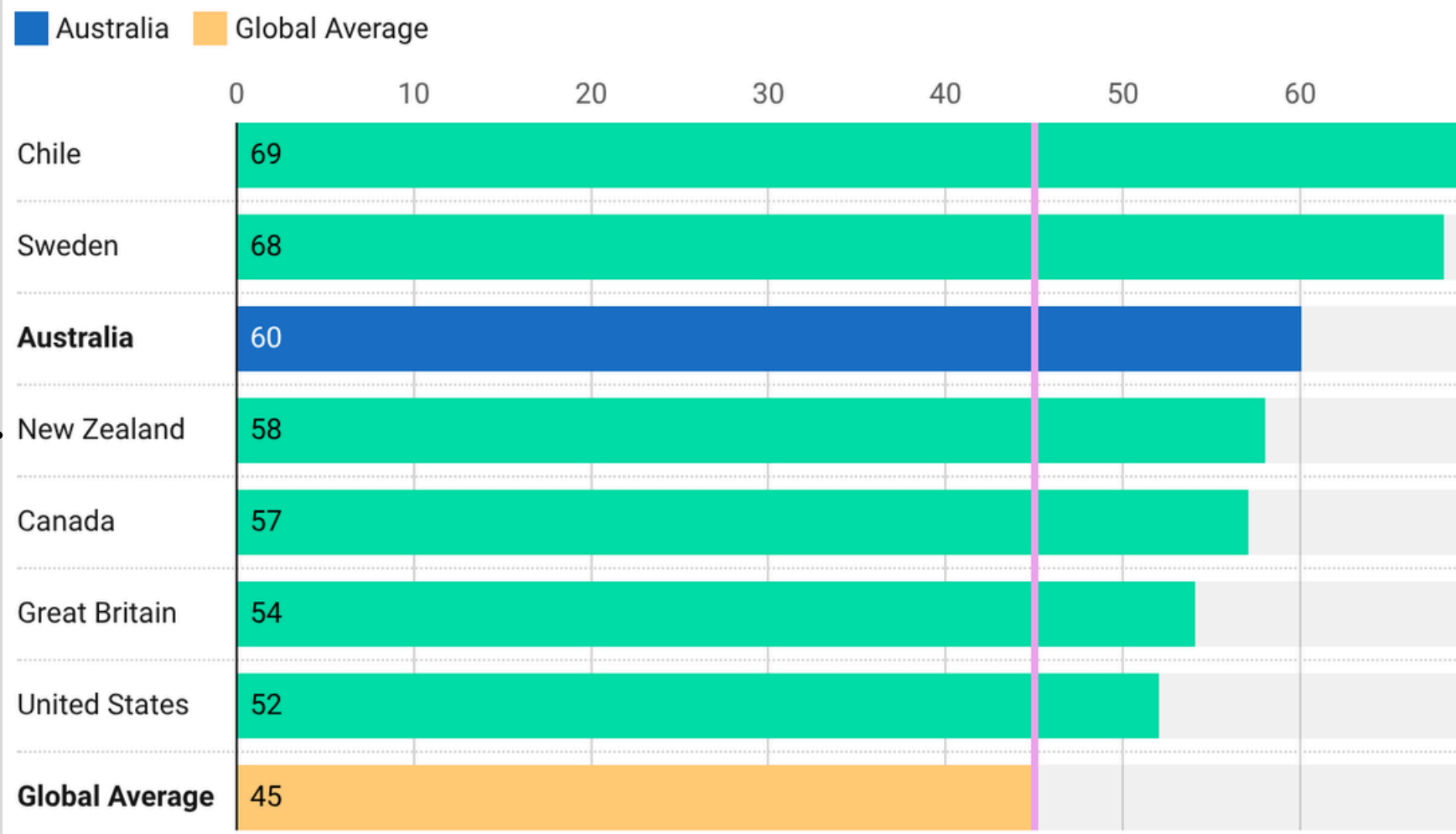
The one element in the entire dashboard that directly answers the persona's question. This is the single insight worth keeping and amplifying. In the pivot, this element was extracted, enlarged, and made the hero of the new Datwrapperr chart.

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Where Does Australia Stand? 2024 Mental Health Concern %

Australia ranks 3rd globally, sitting 15 percentage points above the global average of 45%



× BEFORE — Original VOTD Dashboard Minds for Care · Tableau · Complex & Static	
COUNTRIES SHOWN	31 countries — fixed alphabetical order, no sort, no search
AUSTRALIA VISIBILITY	Buried in row 2 — no highlight, no emphasis, looks identical to all other rows
GLOBAL AVERAGE	Icon bar chart — no axis, no scale, no precise value
TIME TO INSIGHT	3–5 minutes of manual scanning through 31 rows × 5 years
INTERACTIVITY	Fully static — no hover, no filter, no year selector
PERSONA FIT	Designed for data analysts — overwhelming for policy advisors

✓ AFTER — Pivot Visual Datawrapper · Editorial · Instant Clarity · datawrapper.de/_/CNmJB	
COUNTRIES SHOWN	8 countries — ranked highest to lowest by 2024 concern %
AUSTRALIA VISIBILITY	Bold blue bar — instantly the focal point, eye goes there first
GLOBAL AVERAGE	Dashed reference line at 45% — clear visual threshold, no reading required
TIME TO INSIGHT	Under 5 seconds — answer visible at a glance
INTERACTIVITY	Hover tooltips, mobile-friendly, published live URL
PERSONA FIT	Designed for decision-makers — briefing style, no technical knowledge needed